

that they are satisfied that fishing gives them a higher income and part of living than their previous jobs even though some may have used employment to accumulate capital.³

These big fishermen have more land than the other fishermen; 50 per cent have more than 12 daily have farms of over four acres, and 10 per cent have over eleven acres. This compares with over 50 per cent of fishermen having less than 12 daily with farms of less than three acres. The fishermen have farms tend to hire labourers and to grow cash crops, in particular, as well as tobacco, rice, beans, and pineapple, in addition to the staple grains. They also own more cattle; 50 per cent of the fishermen own more than 12 daily own more than six head of cattle (the herds range in size up to thirty-eight head) compared with only 6 per cent for the total sample (Agnew 1970). Furthermore, these big fishermen own more businesses than other fishermen, the proportion increasing from under 10 per cent of those in the lower income groups to 45 per cent of those earning more than 12 daily. These businesses are canteens and stores. A small number of the canteen owners gave gross earnings from this source as ranging between £1 and £9 a week; approximately none of the store owners gave comparable information.

Thus, to sum up, many of these big fishermen are successful entrepreneurs. They have exploited fishing more successfully than others, owning more expensive equipment and employing more labourers. Some gained the capital necessary for long gear from farming or outside employment, while others have worked their way through fishing itself. This group of fishermen are those who gain most from the activities of the Fisheries Department on Lake Chilwa. Most recent information (mid-1972) showed that a few are in the process of buying motorised boats and one or two already have catches large enough to sell direct to large markets to Zambia and Rhodesia. They have exploited other spheres, too. They own grain and cash crops, using paid labourers, often full-time, as well as family labour. They also have larger herds of cattle. This is, in fact, a combination of all fishermen; the survey found that respondents of all ages and income levels put cattle high on their list of desired goods. Cattle are a traditional form of holding wealth; but not only are they a natural bank, they can also be considered an investment in terms of the calves they produce. Certainly for the big fishermen, cattle are a useful hedge against the risks involved in fishing in a lake subject to recession, as well as against the hazards of climate and similar hazards affecting their crops. In addition, they are owners of small businesses such as canteens and stores.

These fishermen thus have a number of sources of income which can cross-fertilise each other. Here is field for further, intensive research: to find out how income flows from one interest to another, how the owner divides his time between them, how he delegates authority and decision-making, and other questions. Above, the spreading of economic interests and investment is of particular

Information on this was only partially elicited by the present survey. Details more detailed enquiry on an individual case-history basis.